

# TEAM LEADER JOB ANALYSIS

Defining Frontline Leadership Through Evidence

Selected Portfolio Sample  
Job Analysis & Talent Systems

Adapted from a larger graduate job analysis conducted in partnership with See Rock City, Inc. (now Rock City Enterprises). This sample highlights the methodology, analytical findings, and organizational application of the work.

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# 1. Business Need & Job Analysis Design

The Team Leader role was a pivotal on-the-floor leadership position distributed across Food, Retail, and Support Services. At the time of the analysis, 30 Team Leaders worked across multiple properties and operating environments. Responsibilities varied by segment, while the organization was also working toward greater consistency in expectations and reviewing leadership structures that still relied on Senior Team Leaders.

|                                                                                       |                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Role variability<br>Responsibilities differed across business segments and locations. | Operational + administrative balance<br>Some Team Leaders carried substantially more administrative work than others. | Organizational evolution<br>Leadership restructuring was underway to create clearer management coverage and role expectations. |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

## Multi-Method Design

|                                   |                               |                         |                                        |
|-----------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| Document Review                   | CEO Stakeholder Interview     | 9 SME Interviews        | Job Analysis Questionnaire Development |
| Quantitative Task & KSAO Analysis | Task-to-KSAO Linkage Analysis | Qualitative Integration | Organizational Recommendations         |

Existing job descriptions and comparable O\*NET profiles informed initial understanding of the role. Qualitative discovery then shaped a Job Analysis Questionnaire (JAQ) containing 12 task statements and 22 KSAOs. Tasks were rated on frequency and importance; KSAOs were rated on importance and whether they were needed at hire.

## 2. SME & Data Collection Strategy

### Study Participation at a Glance

|                                        |                                 |                               |                                        |
|----------------------------------------|---------------------------------|-------------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| <b>32</b>                              | <b>9</b>                        | <b>97%</b>                    | <b>30</b>                              |
| SMEs selected<br>across three segments | SME interviews<br>3 per segment | JAQ response rate<br>31 of 32 | Valid responses<br>after data cleaning |

### Selected SME Composition

| SME Group          | Food | Retail | Support Services | Total |
|--------------------|------|--------|------------------|-------|
| Team Leaders       | 8    | 4      | 5                | 17    |
| Supervisors        | 2    | 3      | 4                | 9     |
| Frontline Partners | 1    | 3      | 2                | 6     |

SME selection. Participants were selected to represent multiple perspectives on the role. Selection criteria emphasized familiarity with Team Leader responsibilities and included incumbents, supervisors, and frontline employees who worked closely with Team Leaders.

Data quality. One response was removed after an incorrectly answered distractor item and a non-differentiated response pattern across importance ratings. The final dataset contained 30 valid responses.

Depth of role knowledge. 83.33% of the final sample interacted with the Team Leader role daily, and 96.66% reported knowing the role very well or extremely well.

Qualitative discovery. Nine SME interviews - three per segment - explored role structure, critical responsibilities, training needs, success factors, and examples of effective and ineffective performance. Findings were used to build and contextualize the JAQ.

### 3. Critical Tasks

Task criticality combined frequency and importance using the project formula Criticality Score = (2 x Importance) + Frequency. The initial statistical threshold was adjusted using the qualitative evidence so that highly important but less-frequent work was not excluded solely because of frequency.

| Rank | Critical Task                                                                  | Criticality Score |
|------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| 1    | Demonstrate appropriate workplace behaviors, in accordance with company values | 15.567            |
| 2    | Maintain the safety and quality standards of the location                      | 15.499            |
| 3    | Supervise daily tasks for a successful shift                                   | 15.366            |
| 4    | Provide guest service to ensure a positive guest experience                    | 15.301            |
| 5    | Ensure compliance with procedures and company policies                         | 15.166            |
| 6    | Collaborate with management, vendors, and peers                                | 13.833            |
| 7    | Monitor inventory to determine stock levels                                    | 13.399            |
| 8    | Conduct on-the-job training for employees                                      | 13.142            |

Why the threshold was adjusted: Four tasks - compliance, collaboration, inventory monitoring, and on-the-job training - were strongly supported in interviews. On-the-job training, for example, had a high importance mean (4.621) but a lower frequency mean (3.900), illustrating why frequency alone could understate an important responsibility.

## 4. Critical KSAOs

KSAOs were evaluated on both importance and necessity at hire. For the overall analysis, the final critical set used an importance threshold of 4.43 and at least 90% agreement that the KSAO was needed at hire.

| Critical | KSAO                                | Importance | Mean | Needed  | at Hire |
|----------|-------------------------------------|------------|------|---------|---------|
|          | Dependability                       | 4.767      |      | 100.00% |         |
|          | Customer Service                    | 4.700      |      | 90.00%  |         |
|          | Oral Communication Skills           | 4.667      |      | 100.00% |         |
|          | Work Ethic                          | 4.667      |      | 100.00% |         |
|          | Active Listening                    | 4.633      |      | 100.00% |         |
|          | Problem-Solving & Critical Thinking | 4.567      |      | 93.33%  |         |
|          | Self-Control                        | 4.564      |      | 96.67%  |         |
|          | Leadership & Team Building          | 4.533      |      | 96.67%  |         |
|          | Adaptability & Flexibility          | 4.533      |      | 96.67%  |         |
|          | Social Perceptiveness & Empathy     | 4.433      |      | 93.33%  |         |
|          | Organization                        | 4.433      |      | 93.33%  |         |
|          | Time Management Skills              | 4.433      |      | 90.00%  |         |

Selection vs. development insight. Operational Knowledge (importance mean 4.633; 40% needed at hire) and Coaching & Developing Others (4.500; 73.33% needed at hire) were important to performance but did not meet the overall needed-at-hire criterion. The analysis therefore treated these as important, trainable capabilities rather than universal selection requirements.

## 5. Task-to-KSAO Linkage

The linkage analysis evaluated whether each critical KSAO was necessary for performing each critical task. Four job analysts independently rated each relationship on a five-point utility scale; ratings were averaged, and a mean of at least 4.0 established a linkage.

| Selected Critical Task                                                  | KSAOs Linked at Mean >= 4.0                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Demonstrate appropriate workplace behaviors aligned with company values | Dependability • Work Ethic • Self-Control • Leadership & Team Building • Time Management • Social Perceptiveness & Empathy                                                                                                                              |
| Maintain safety and quality standards                                   | Dependability • Oral Communication • Self-Control • Problem-Solving & Critical Thinking • Time Management • Organization                                                                                                                                |
| Supervise daily tasks for a successful shift                            | Dependability • Work Ethic • Oral Communication • Active Listening • Self-Control • Problem-Solving & Critical Thinking • Leadership & Team Building • Adaptability & Flexibility • Time Management • Social Perceptiveness & Empathy                   |
| Conduct on-the-job training for employees                               | Customer Service • Work Ethic • Oral Communication • Active Listening • Self-Control • Problem-Solving & Critical Thinking • Leadership & Team Building • Adaptability & Flexibility • Time Management • Organization • Social Perceptiveness & Empathy |

Why linkage matters: The analysis did not stop at identifying desirable characteristics. It tested whether the critical KSAOs were actually useful for executing the critical work of the Team Leader role, strengthening the connection between job requirements and downstream talent decisions.

## 6. From Analysis to Organizational Application

At the time of the project, See Rock City, Inc. was reviewing frontline leadership structures and seeking greater consistency in Team Leader expectations. The stakeholder interview specifically identified disparity in responsibilities across teams and ongoing leadership restructuring.

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Organizational question                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| How should frontline leadership responsibilities be defined as the organization reconsidered the Senior Team Leader structure?                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| Evidence from the analysis                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| Administrative duties such as email correspondence, scheduling, and shift attendance were included in the JAQ but ranked below the eight critical tasks in the overall Team Leader analysis (criticality score 12.272). The broader findings reinforced a core Team Leader role centered on on-the-floor leadership, standards, shift execution, guest service, collaboration, inventory, and on-the-job training. |
| Subsequent organizational use                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| As the organization later restructured these positions, the analysis helped inform a distinction between Team Leader 1 and Team Leader 2. Employees carrying additional administrative responsibilities were not simply treated as equivalent to the standard Team Leader role; the differentiated structure preserved recognition of those additional responsibilities and corresponding pay distinction.         |

### Broader Talent Applications

|                  |                        |                          |
|------------------|------------------------|--------------------------|
| Selection        | Training & Development | Performance Expectations |
| Job Descriptions | Role Differentiation   | Leadership Development   |

The project illustrates how job analysis can move beyond documenting responsibilities and provide evidence for selection, training, performance management, and role-design decisions.

## 7. Practitioner Reflection

### What Worked

The project combined broad SME representation with qualitative and quantitative methods, allowing findings to be tested across three distinct business segments. In less than three months, the team moved from organizational discovery through interviews, JAQ development and administration, data cleaning, analysis, linkage, recommendations, and a final presentation to HR stakeholders.

### What I Would Strengthen

With additional time and organizational access, I would expand strategic discovery at the beginning of the project. We understood that the Senior Team Leader structure was under review, but we did not have complete visibility into the organization's evolving workforce strategy. Earlier conversations about the anticipated future state could have helped frame the analysis and recommendations even more strategically.

I would also build a stronger communication plan to close the loop with participating SMEs. Employees contributed meaningful time and expertise to defining the work, and where organizational confidentiality allows, participants should have an opportunity to understand how their input informed subsequent decisions.

### My Role

Project Lead & Primary Organizational Contact. Coordinated project execution and organizational access; served as liaison with stakeholders; conducted the in-person SME interviews; provided organizational and job-specific context as a supervisor of the role; contributed collaboratively to JAQ development and quantitative analysis; fact-checked findings and written deliverables; conducted the task-to-KSAO linkage analysis; and supported final recommendations and presentation to the HR team.

#### Portfolio Note

This is a selected sample from a larger collaborative graduate job analysis project conducted in partnership with See Rock City, Inc. It is intended to demonstrate methodology, analytical reasoning, and organizational application rather than reproduce the complete organizational deliverable.